NCERT Summary: Topic 22: Consumer Rights — Raw Notes

Source Integration

- Class 10, Chapter 5: Consumer Rights

Core Factual & Conceptual Architecture

1. Market Power Imbalance and Consumer Movement

- Market Asymmetry: Producers possess superior information and resources compared to individual consumers, historically governed by "caveat emptor" (let the buyer beware).
- Consumer Movement: Emerged to counter exploitation such as adulteration, underweight measures, overcharging, and misleading advertising, culminating in the Consumer Protection Act of 1986 (COPRA) and its 2019 update.

2. Six Fundamental Consumer Rights

- Right to Safety: Protection against hazardous goods and services.
- Right to Information: Mandatory labeling of ingredients, MRP, expiry dates, and batch numbers.
- Right to Choose: Access to diverse goods and services at competitive prices.
- Right to be Heard: Representation and consideration of consumer interests in appropriate forums.
- Right to Seek Redressal: Compensation and legal recourse against unfair trade practices.
- Right to Consumer Education: Lifelong acquisition of knowledge to remain an informed consumer.

3. Quality Certification and Three-Tier Redressal

- Quality Marks: ISI for industrial goods, AGMARK for agricultural grading, Hallmark for precious metals, and FSSAI for packaged foods.
- Three-Tier Redressal System: District Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission (lower claims), State Commission (mid-value claims and appeals), and National Commission (highest-value claims and apex appeals).
- Consumer Responsibilities: Active vigilance, demanding bills, checking quality marks, and participating in awareness campaigns like "Jago Grahak Jago."

✍ Notes & Updates